

Exploiting POST-based XSSI

Exploiting POST-based XSSI - @1lastBr3ath, Prakash, DON'T BE A 5KIDDO, BE A HACKER.

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Content

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We know, more and more [client-side attacks are dying](#). But sometimes, with introduction of new features, an unexploitable becomes exploitable. Yes, combined with the power of Service Worker, XSSI is no longer limited to GET requests.

This essentially means we can also include resources with POST requests and [CORS-safelisted](#) headers. The idea is simple- intercept the request and modify to send *no-cors* POST request. For demonstration purpose, I've built a rough POC at; <https://cm2.pw/poc/chrome/xssi.php>

It roughly looks like;

```
<script>
  navigator.serviceWorker.register('sw.js');
  window.addEventListener('DOMContentLoaded', event => {
    if(typeof(email)=== 'undefined')
      location.reload();
    else
      alert(email);
  });
</script>
<script src='/intercept'></script>
```

Where **sw.js** is as follows;

```
self.addEventListener('fetch', event => {
  const url = 'https://victim.cm2.pw/xss?text/plain';
  if(event.request.url.endsWith('/intercept'))
    event.respondWith(fetch(url, {
      method : 'POST',
      //mode : 'no-cors',
      credentials: 'include',
      body : 'xss=email="[[email protected]](https://blog.cm2.pw/cdn-cgi/l/email-protection)";',
      headers : {'Content-type':'application/x-www-form-urlencoded'}
    }));
});
```

Things worth noting here are;

- The `<script>` URL, if requested directly, returns 404 Not Found
- The request is intercepted and a POST request is sent to vulnerable endpoint instead
- The returned content is valid JavaScript, reason we're able to read *email*

The only purpose of `<script src>` above is to serve as a middleman, allowing us to intercept and modify the request on the fly. And, it doesn't necessarily have to be the vulnerable endpoint. So, with **sw.js**, we intercept the initial request and send one as required to the vulnerable endpoint. In this particular demo, a POST request with body set to email. We're sending a `no-cors` request, meaning we cannot really read the response. However, as long as the response is valid JavaScript and has some side effects, it's possible to leak contents cross-origin. The response here is identical to JavaScript variable declaration, `email` is assigned a value which we can access directly under `window` scope.

Interestingly, I've observed many applications setting `Content-type` to whatever was sent in `Accept` header. Though, not much of help but definitely a savior when **CORB** triggers.

Actually, we don't normally find XSSi these days and there's already enough protection in place. Therefore, an issue has been created in public on GitHub to discuss about potential solutions to the standard; <https://github.com/w3c/ServiceWorker/issues/1509>